

The Listening Lab

Eight strategies. One routine. Zero panic on exam day.

How this works

Every unit has **one listening sheet** (this booklet) built around a podcast episode — *In the Lab FM* — made from the readings of this course, plus one optional video. You always listen **twice**: first for the general idea, then for one specific skill. You know the task *before* you press play. Your completed sheet goes to your **portfolio** (30% of your grade), and the listening section of each written exam uses **the same formats** you practice here. The SELLI exam at the end of the semester requires 480 points: these are the same question types.

The eight strategies

#	Strategy	You practice it in	Exam question it prepares
L1	Gist — what is it about?	every unit	<i>What is the talk mainly about?</i>
L2	Key information	Unit 6 (magnetism)	numbers, names, processes
L3	Fact vs. opinion	Unit 7 (tourism)	<i>What does the speaker think...?</i>
L4	Order of events	Unit 7 (travel stories)	sequencing
L5	Inference — the unsaid	Unit 8 (future of work)	<i>What does the speaker imply?</i>
L6	Form → meaning	Unit 9 (language change)	vocabulary in context
L7	Specific words	Unit 10 (procrastination)	<i>What does X mean by...?</i>
L8	Predict before you listen	every unit (Part 0)	saves time on every question

The routine

- **Warm ears** (weekly, 5 min): short-dialogue drills, SELLI style, corrected on the spot.
- **Main session** (weekly, 15–20 min): the unit episode with this sheet.
- **SELLI Gym** (every two weeks, 10 min): 8 timed questions; keep your personal score.

Training wheels come off

The support you get shrinks during the semester — on purpose. The SELLI plays the audio **once**, at natural speed, with no transcript. By November, so do we.

Phase	Units	Conditions
Supported	6–7	0.9× speed allowed · questions read <i>before</i> listening · transcript after 2nd listen
Intermediate	8–9	natural speed · transcript only to check your mistakes
Exam mode	10 + review	natural speed · some items played once · no transcript

How your sheet is graded

Each sheet is worth 10 points inside your portfolio: Part 0 and Listening 1 (2 pts), Listening 2 (5 pts), Language hunt (2 pts), Self-check honestly completed (1 pt). **What counts is evidence of listening, not perfection:** a wrong answer with the phrase you actually heard written next to it earns more than a lucky guess.

Golden rules

1. Read the task first. Always. That *is* strategy L8.
2. First listen: pen down. Just understand what it is about.
3. Second listen: hunt. You know exactly what you are hunting for.
4. Never write while the key sentence is playing — hold it in your head, write after.
5. A word you missed is gone. Let it go; the next sentence is coming.

Unit 6 — In the Lab

Strategy focus: **L2** Key information + **L1** Gist + **L8** Predict

Name:

Group:

Date:

Part 0 — Before you listen

predict (L8) · 3 min

Three key words from the episode: **magnet** · **field** · **attract**.

a) Two things you expect the hosts to talk about:

1. 2.

b) One thing you already know about magnetism:

Listening 1 — Gist

pen down, just listen (L1) · 5 min

What is the episode mainly about? **Circle one**.

- a) The history of the compass and who invented it.
- b) What magnetism is, how it works, and where we use it every day.
- c) Why some metals are more expensive than others.

Main idea in **one** sentence:

.....

Listening 2 — Key Info Grid

hunt for data (L2) · 8 min

Fill the grid with information **from the episode**. Write the exact words you hear when you can.

I am hunting for...	What I heard		
A number + what it refers to			
A name (person or place)			
A process, in steps	1.	2.	3.
One everyday example			

Now answer, SELLI style. **Circle one** per item.

1. According to the hosts, a magnetic field...
- a) can be seen with special glasses b) is invisible but real c) only exists in laboratories
2. The hosts mention an everyday object that uses magnetism. Which one?
- a) the one they describe in the episode b) — c) — (options on the board, from the generated episode)

Language hunt

catch the collocations · 2 min

Catch two **adverb** + **adjective** collocations (Unit 6 vocabulary), full phrase:

1. 2.

☒ **Self-check.** My score: / 10 The hardest part was: ☐ gist ☐ details ☐ speed ☐ vocabulary

Tell a classmate who missed the episode what it was about (2 sentences):

.....

.....

Extension (optional homework). Watch: *MAGNETS: How Do They Work?* (Veritasium / MinutePhysics, YouTube, ~4 min)

Task: write down TWO key pieces of information (L2) the video gives that the episode did not. Bring them to class.

Unit 7 — Hit the Road

Episode: *Paradise at What Price? (overtourism)*Strategy focus: **L3** Fact vs. opinion + **L4** Order of events + **L8** Predict

Name:

Group:

Date:

Part 0 — Before you listen

predict (L8) · 3 min

This episode is a **debate**: one host defends tourism development, the other criticizes it.

- a) One argument you expect **in favor**:
- b) One argument you expect **against**:

Listening 1 — Gist

pen down (L1) · 5 min

Which sentence best describes the debate? **Circle one**.

- a) Both hosts agree that tourism should stop completely.
- b) They discuss whether tourism helps or harms the places tourists visit.
- c) They compare prices of different vacation destinations.

Listening 2 — Fact-Check the Hosts

fact or opinion? (L3) · 8 min

Write **four statements you hear** (short version is fine). Mark F (fact) or O (opinion) and — this is the important part — write the **signal phrase** that told you.

Statement I heard	F / O	Signal phrase
1.		
2.		
3.		
4.		

Signal phrase bank — facts: *according to...*, *the data shows...*, *in [year]...*, *[number] percent...* · opinions: *I think...*, *to me...*, *it seems...*, *clearly...*, *they should...*

Order of events (L4). The critical host tells a short story about one place. Number these moments 1–3 as you hear them:

- ☐ the place became famous ☐ prices went up for local people ☐ tourists arrived in large numbers

Language hunt

catch the compounds · 2 min

Catch two **compound adjectives** (Unit 7 vocabulary: *eco-friendly*, *well-known*, *low-cost...*) in the phrases where they appear:

1. 2.

☒ **Self-check.** My score: / 10 The hardest part was: ☐ gist ☐ details ☐ speed ☐ vocabulary

Tell a classmate who missed the episode what it was about (2 sentences):

.....

.....

Extension (optional homework). Watch: *DW Documentary on overtourism (Venice / Barcelona, YouTube — your teacher gives the exact clip, ~5 min)*

Task: find ONE fact and ONE opinion in the clip. Write each with its signal phrase.

Unit 8 — Future Innovations

Strategy focus: **L5** Inference + **L1** Gist + **L8** Predict

Name:

Group:

Date:

Part 0 — Before you listen

predict (L8) · 3 min

- a) Name two jobs you think machines will do in 20 years: 1.
 2.
 b) One job you think is safe, and why:

Listening 1 — Gist

pen down (L1) · 5 min

The hosts' overall attitude about the future of work is... **Circle one.**

- a) totally pessimistic — machines win b) balanced — some jobs change, new skills matter c) totally optimistic — nothing will change

Listening 2 — Read Between the Lines

what do they imply? (L5) · 8 min

Said, implied, or not there? For each idea, mark: **S** (they said it directly), **I** (they didn't say it, but they implied it), **N** (it is not in the episode). Careful: **implied** means you can defend it with something they *did* say.

Idea	S / I / N
1. Repetitive tasks are the easiest for machines to take over.	
2. Human skills like creativity will become more valuable.	
3. Students should choose careers that machines cannot copy easily.	
4. Machines will completely replace teachers.	

For **one** idea you marked **I**, write the phrase from the episode that supports your inference:

Idea # evidence:

Language hunt

catch the three-part verbs · 2 min

Catch two **phrasal-prepositional verbs** (Unit 8: *keep up with*, *put up with*, *look forward to*...):

1. 2.

📝 **Self-check.** My score: / 10 The hardest part was: ☐ gist ☐ details ☐ speed ☐ vocabulary

Tell a classmate who missed the episode what it was about (2 sentences):

.....

🎬 **Extension (optional homework).** Watch: *TED: The jobs we'll lose to machines — and the ones we won't* (Anthony Goldbloom, ~5 min)

Task: the speaker implies something about what students should study. Write the inference **AND** the sentence that supports it.

Unit 9 — Trendsetter

Episode: *The Words We Wear (fashion & language)*Strategy focus: **L6** Form → meaning + **L1** Gist + **L8** Predict

Name:

Group:

Date:

Part 0 — Before you listen

predict (L8) · 3 min

English invents words by **blending** (*glamping* = glamorous + camping), adding **prefixes/suffixes** (*oversized*, *stylish*), and **compounding** (*streetwear*).

Invent a guess: what could **athleisure** mean?

Listening 1 — Gist

pen down (L1) · 5 min

The episode mainly discusses... **Circle one.**

- a) how fashion trends create new English words b) the history of a famous clothing brand c) why fashion magazines are disappearing

Listening 2 — Word Catcher

use the form to guess the meaning (L6) · 8 min

The hosts use **four** invented or recently-created words. Catch them and work them out.

Word I caught	Parts I recognize	My guess at the meaning
1.		
2.		
3.		
4.		

Confirm with context: for word #1, what was the sentence around it about?

.....

Did the context confirm your guess from the form? ☐ yes ☐ partly ☐ no

Language hunt

catch the noun modifiers · 2 min

Catch two **noun** + **noun** combinations (Unit 9: *dress code*, *production line*...):

1. 2.

☒ **Self-check.** My score: / 10 The hardest part was: ☐ gist ☐ details ☐ speed ☐ vocabulary

Tell a classmate who missed the episode what it was about (2 sentences):

.....

🎧 **Extension (optional homework).** Watch: *TED: What makes a word "real"? (Anne Curzan, ~17 min — watch minutes 0–6)*

Task: the speaker mentions words that dictionaries recently accepted. Catch ONE and explain its parts.

Unit 10 — Mind Over Matter

Episode: *The Art of Doing It Tomorrow (procrastination)*Strategy focus: **L7** Specific words + **L1** Gist + **L8** Predict

Name:

Group:

Date:

Part 0 — Before you listen

predict (L8) · 3 min

a) Are you a procrastinator? ☐ always ☐ sometimes ☐ never

b) The task you always postpone:

Listening 1 — Gist

pen down (L1) · 5 min

The hosts' main message is... **Circle one.**

a) procrastination is a moral failure and lazy people cannot change b) procrastination has psychological causes and there are concrete ways to manage it c) postponing tasks always improves the final result

Listening 2 — Phrasal Verb Bingo

catch the exact words (L7) · 8 min

Exam mode: one listen only. Mark each phrasal verb when you hear it and write one word of its context next to it (e.g. *put off* → "homework").

☐ put off context:	☐ get down to context:	☐ catch up on context:
☐ end up context:	☐ give up context:	☐ deal with context:
☐ get around to context:	☐ carry on context:	☐ work out context:

Line? Three in a row = **BINGO**. Full card = legend status.Now, from memory — **complete the phrase you heard:** "Stop it and just
it"

Language hunt

catch the goal phrases · 2 min

Catch two **verb phrases about goals** (Unit 10: *dream big, break it down, put your mind to it...*):

1. 2.

Self-check. My score: / 10 The hardest part was: ☐ gist ☐ details ☐ speed ☐ vocabulary**Tell a classmate who missed the episode what it was about (2 sentences):**.....
..... **Extension (optional homework).** Watch: *TED: Inside the mind of a master procrastinator (Tim Urban, ~14 min)*

Task: catch the three characters the speaker invents (a decision-maker, an animal, a monster) and what each one represents.

Any unit — Listening Sheet

Episode:

Strategy focus: **L?** your teacher announces the focus

Name:

Group:

Date:

Part 0 — Before you listen

predict (L8) · 3 min

Key words on the board:

I predict this audio is about:

Listening 1 — Gist

pen down (L1) · 5 min

Main idea in one sentence:
.....**Listening 2 — Focus task**

your teacher dictates the task · 8 min

I am hunting for...

What I heard

Language hunt

catch the unit vocabulary · 2 min

1. 2.

☒ **Self-check.** My score: / 10 The hardest part was: ☐ gist ☐ details ☐ speed ☐ vocabulary**Tell a classmate who missed the episode what it was about (2 sentences):**.....
.....